

DAN LANDAYAN

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Ph.D. neuroscientist with over a decade of research experience and 8 peer-reviewed publications — including first-author studies in *eLife* and *Nature Scientific Reports* and co-authored work in *Cell* — applying quantitative and analytical expertise toward data science and AI.

EXPERIENCE

Postdoctoral Scholar

Stanford, CA

Stanford University — Shah Lab

2019 – 2024

- Investigated hypothalamic neural circuits underlying social behavior; co-authored “Hypothalamic neurons that mirror aggression,” published in *Cell* (2023).
- Awarded competitive fellowships including the Ben Barres Postdoctoral Fellowship and an NIH Diversity Supplement; selected as an HHMI Hanna Gray finalist.
- Completed formal research-mentor training (CIMER; Stanford Mentoring Fundamentals) and mentored trainees as a SACNAS postdoctoral advisor.

Instructor of Record

San José, CA

San José State University (CSU) — General Genetics

2024

- Designed and taught an undergraduate General Genetics course as the sole Instructor of Record.

Graduate Researcher

Merced, CA

University of California, Merced — Wolf Lab

2013 – 2019

- First-authored two studies on the neural basis of motivated behavior: thirst interneurons in *eLife* (2021) and dopaminergic control of foraging in *Nature Scientific Reports* (2018).
- Mapped central neural circuitry for water- and food-seeking behavior in *Drosophila* using genetic and behavioral assays.
- Served as Teaching Assistant for Human Physiology; awarded the UC President’s Dissertation Year Fellowship and the Dean’s Distinguished Scholar Fellowship.

SELECTED PUBLICATIONS

Landayan, D. S., et al. Thirst interneurons that promote water seeking and limit feeding behavior in *Drosophila*. *eLife* (2021). (*first author*) doi:10.7554/eLife.66286

Landayan, D. S., Feldman, D. S., Wolf, F. W. Satiation state-dependent dopaminergic control of foraging in *Drosophila*. *Nature Scientific Reports* (2018). (*first author*) doi:10.1038/s41598-018-24217-1

Yang, T., ... Landayan, D., ... Shah, N. M. Hypothalamic neurons that mirror aggression. *Cell* (2023). doi:10.1016/j.cell.2023.01.022

Ramirez, D. O., Wang, B. P., Landayan, D., Kaur, G., Wolf, F. W. A single NPFR neuropeptide F receptor neuron that regulates thirst behaviors in *Drosophila*. *eNeuro* (2025). (*Featured Article*) doi:10.1523/ENEURO.0259-25.2025

Landayan, D. S., Wolf, F. W. Shared neurocircuitry underlying feeding and drugs of abuse in *Drosophila*. *Biomedical Journal* (2015). doi:10.1016/j.bj.2016.01.004

Additional peer-reviewed publications in Experimental Neurology (2018), Genes, Brain and Behavior (2016), and Frontiers in Integrative Neuroscience (2023).

SKILLS & TRAINING

Machine Learning & Mathematics: Probability & Statistics for Machine Learning; Linear Algebra, Multivariate Calculus, and PCA for Machine Learning (DeepLearning.AI · Imperial College London, 2025)

Programming & Tools: Python, PyTorch, Git / GitHub

Research Methods: Neural-circuit mapping, *Drosophila* genetics & optogenetics, behavioral neuroscience assays, scientific writing & publication

EDUCATION

University of California, Merced

Merced, CA

Ph.D. in Quantitative and Systems Biology (QSB)

2013 – 2019

University of California, Davis

Davis, CA

B.S. in Neurobiology, Physiology, and Behavior

2007 – 2011